Turnover coordination that protects the *sequence*

What I built to keep turnover trades moving in order, what broke, and what I changed.

Out of order means paying twice

01 **Trades depend on order**
Repairs, painting, flooring, and cleaning have fixed order.

02 **One early contractor**
Clean before repairs or paint, and the unit must be cleaned again.

Turning over an apartment takes five or more separate trades. If one contractor works out of order, fresh work gets ruined and costs double.

From contractor text to reviewed handoff

WHEN A TRADE FINISHES

Contractor text	→ Match unit	→ Check trade order

BEFORE NEXT DISPATCH

Draft handoff	→ Manager review	→ Send email or text

The next contractor is only notified after a manager approves.

I built a workflow that catches informal trade completions, checks physical sequence rules, drafts the next handoff, and brings it to a manager.

AI interprets. The manager dispatches.

AI assists

Parse messy texts

Identify unit hint

Draft next notice

Manager decides

Resolve ambiguity

Pick email or text

Approve each dispatch

AI handles messy contractor texts and prepares draft notices. The property manager verifies the work, picks the channel, and approves every outward message.

Physical order belongs in code

01 Fixed dependencies

Repairs before paint. Paint before flooring. Cleaning last.

02 Hard sequence guard

If a cleaner reports done while repairs remain open, the system halts.

03 Clear reason given

The manager sees exactly which prior trade is still pending.

Software should not let a language model guess whether floors can be installed before paint is dry. Hard dependency rules reject out-of-order completions automatically.

An email reply was silently ignored

THE GAP

Contractor replies →	**Header in metadata** →	~~**Reply dropped**~~
	Treated as outgoing copy	

THE FIX

Read metadata →	**Extract thread ID** →	**Link to unit**
	Threaded replies now route to the active turnover unit.	

An email reader placed header lines inside metadata rather than the main header object. Without thread headers, real contractor replies were treated as outgoing copies and ignored.

Sync ~~lost links~~ after batch one

THE BUG

Batch 1 mapped → **Batch 2 unmapped** → **~~Broken links~~**

THE FIX

Batch responses → **Pair each by index** → **All records linked**

Every batch response is now matched to its input items.

The workspace sync ran once for all items, but only saved identifiers from the first batch. Later turnover stages updated without links until I paired each batch by index.

Uncertainty needs a person

WHAT COMES IN	WHAT HAPPENS
Two units match text	Manager chooses unit
Bare message with no unit	Escalate to manager
Out-of-order trade report	Block advance with reason
Unconfigured channel	Alert manager, do not send

When a contractor text is vague or multiple units match, the system stops. It never guesses an apartment unit or sends on an unconfigured channel.

Coordination breaks at the seams

The informal text

↓

The ambiguous unit

↓

The out-of-order report

↓

The double-tapped button

Building this changed how I view turnover automation. The challenge is rarely connecting an API; it is handling messy texts, missing headers, and out-of-order reports safely.

I checked the awkward cases

I CHECKED	RECORDED BEHAVIOR
Informal trade slang	Understood unit and intent
Ambiguous property name	Escalated for manager choice
Cleaning before paint	Advance blocked with reason
Approve tapped twice	No duplicate dispatch sent

I checked messy wording, ambiguous addresses, out-of-order completions, and duplicate button presses to confirm the workflow behaves predictably under real operating conditions.

What I'd improve next

01 **Standardized photo intake**
Collect photo evidence before approving expensive trades.

02 **Two-way arrival tracking**
Confirm contractor arrival windows before alerting the next trade.

03 **Accounting system write-back**
Close work orders and post invoices automatically once approved.

Next, I would add structured photo inspection checklists before sign-off and two-way arrival confirmations, reducing turnover delays even further.